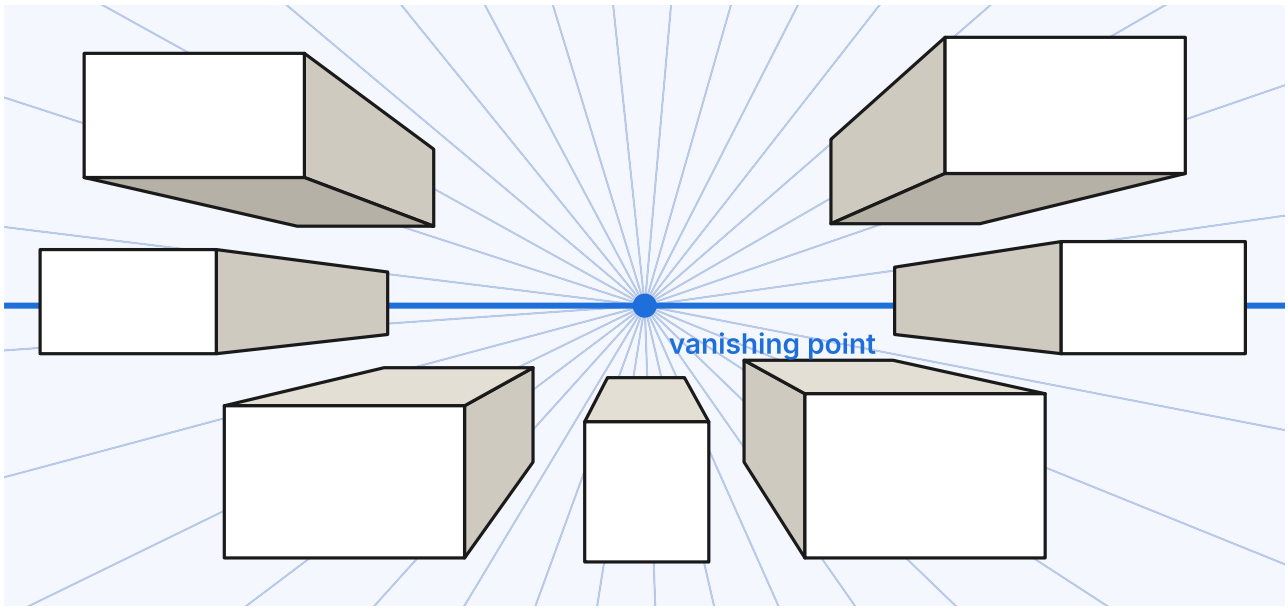
6 Beginner Drills

Six short, printable exercises that build your perspective skills one step at a time. 10 to 20 minutes each, with a ready-made practice sheet for every drill.



DRILL 1 · 15 MIN
9 Boxes
1-point perspective

DRILL 2 · 20 MIN
The Hallway
1-point perspective

DRILL 3 · 20 MIN
10 Boxes
2-point perspective

DRILL 4 · 20 MIN
The Tower
3-point perspective

DRILL 5 · 20 MIN
Misty Mountains
Aerial perspective

DRILL 6 · 10 MIN
Eye Level
The golden rule

Before You Start

How to get the most out of these drills

What you need

- A pencil (HB or 2B) and an eraser
- A ruler or any straight edge
- Plain paper, or print the practice sheets in this workbook
- Optional: a colored pencil to mark vanishing points
- A timer on your phone

4 rules for every drill

- **Light first, dark last.** Sketch guide lines lightly, then darken the final lines.
- **Keep your guides.** They show your thinking. Don't erase them.
- **Use the timer.** Stop when it rings, even if it isn't perfect.
- **Repeat it 3 times** on different days. That's how it sticks.

Ask these 3 questions before every drawing

1. **Where are my eyes?** Draw the horizon line first. It is your eye level.
2. **How many sets of parallel depth lines do I have?** That number is how many vanishing points you need.
3. **Are my vanishing points far enough apart?** More distance gives a more natural image.

The golden rule

If you draw while standing, the eyes of every person of similar height standing on the same ground, near or far, sit right on the horizon line. Only the size of their bodies changes.

Suggested plan

One drill a day for six days, then repeat the ones that felt hardest. Pairs well with the free *7 Types of Perspective* cheat sheet.

How each page works

Every drill has a goal, simple steps, a way to check yourself, and a practice sheet with the horizon line and vanishing points already drawn. Print the sheet, or copy it onto your own paper.

1 9 Boxes

1-point perspective · The straight-on view

15 min

Goal

Learn which faces of a box you can see above, on and below the horizon.

Steps

1. Use the horizon line and vanishing point (VP) on the sheet.
2. Draw 9 front faces: three above the horizon, three on it, three below.
3. Connect the corners of each face to the VP with light lines.
4. Close each box with one horizontal and one vertical line.

Check yourself

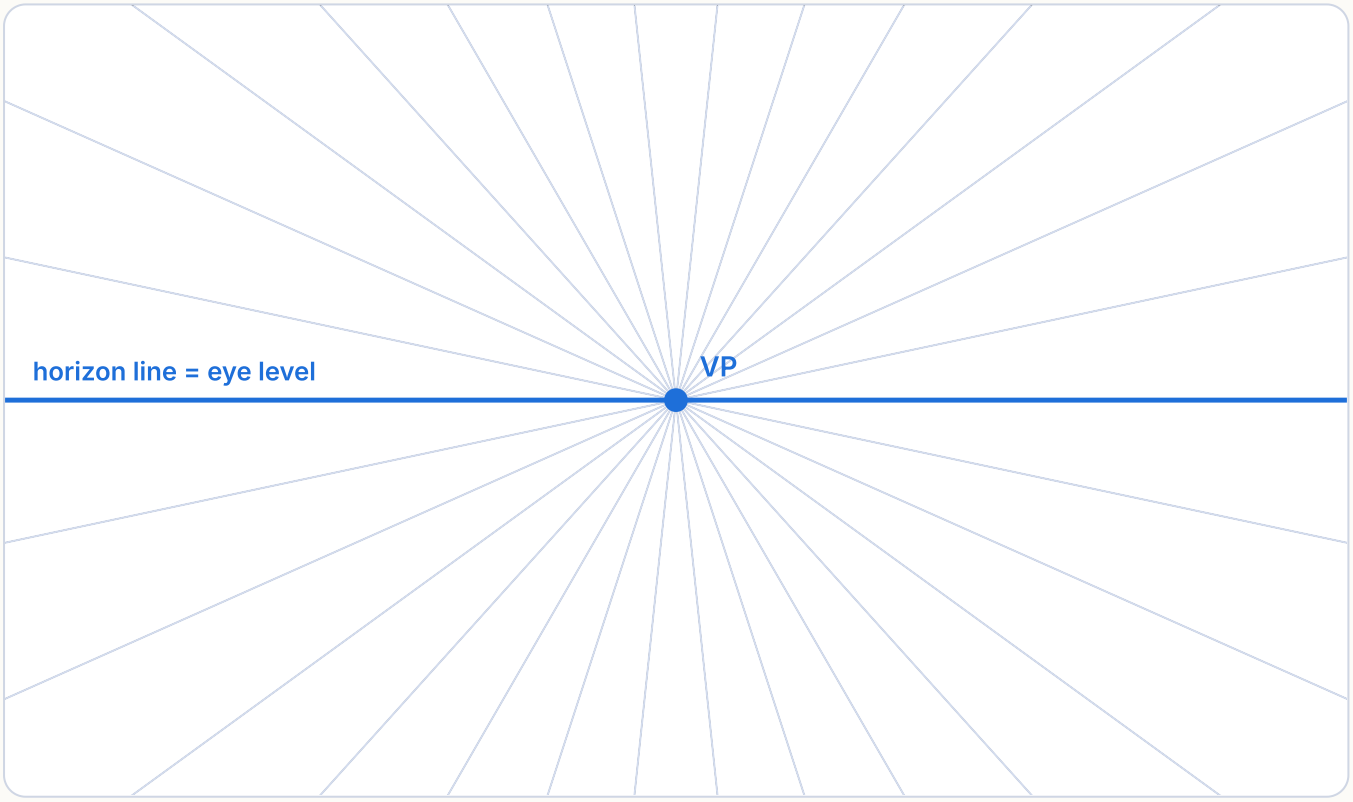
- Boxes **above** the horizon show their bottom.
- Boxes **below** it show their top.
- Boxes **on** it show neither top nor bottom.
- Horizontals stay horizontal. Verticals stay vertical.

Common mistake

Too much depth. A box pulled too far toward the VP looks stretched and unreal.

PRACTICE SHEET

Print it or copy it by hand



2 The Hallway

1-point perspective · Rooms and streets seen head-on

20 min

Goal

Turn the one-point box into a space you can walk into.

Steps

1. The back wall and the four corner lines are already drawn on the sheet.
2. Add a door and two windows. Draw their near edges as verticals, then run their tops and bottoms to the VP.
3. Add floor lines across the hallway. Space them closer together as they go back.
4. Shade the far end lightest and the near end darkest.

Check yourself

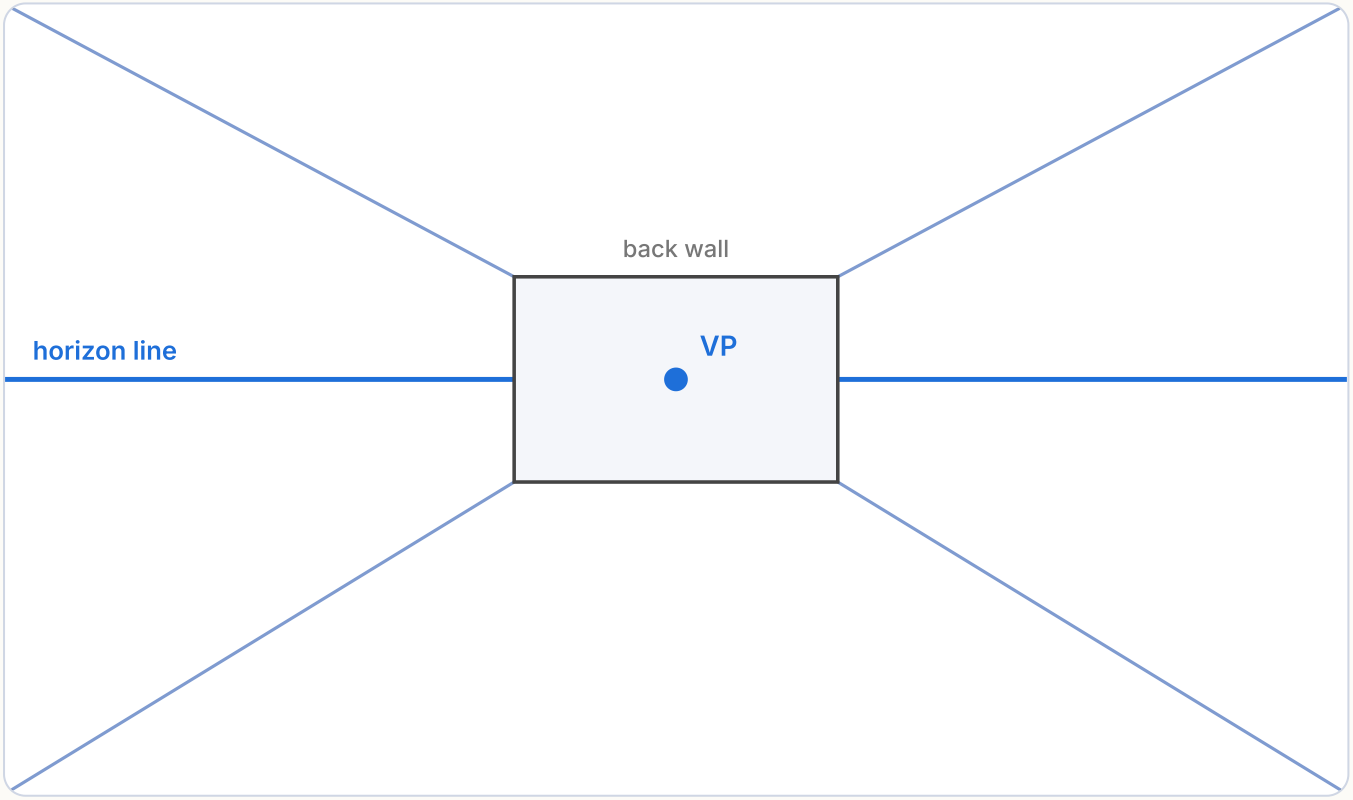
- Every line that goes into the distance points at the VP.
- Door and window tops line up with the same VP line.
- Floor lines are perfectly horizontal.

Pro tip

Don't put the VP dead center. Shifting it a little makes the composition feel more natural and interesting.

PRACTICE SHEET

Add the door, windows and floor



3 10 Boxes

2-point perspective · The corner view

20 min

Goal

See how a corner turns into two sets of depth lines, one for each VP.

Steps

1. Use the horizon with its two far-apart vanishing points.
2. Draw the nearest vertical edge of a box.
3. Connect its top and bottom to both VPs.
4. Add two more vertical edges to set the width, then connect the new corners back to the VPs.
5. Repeat until you have 10 boxes: some above, some on and some below the horizon.

Check yourself

- Only the vertical lines stay vertical.
- Boxes above the horizon show their bottom, boxes below show their top.
- Your corners look natural, not sharp.

Common mistake

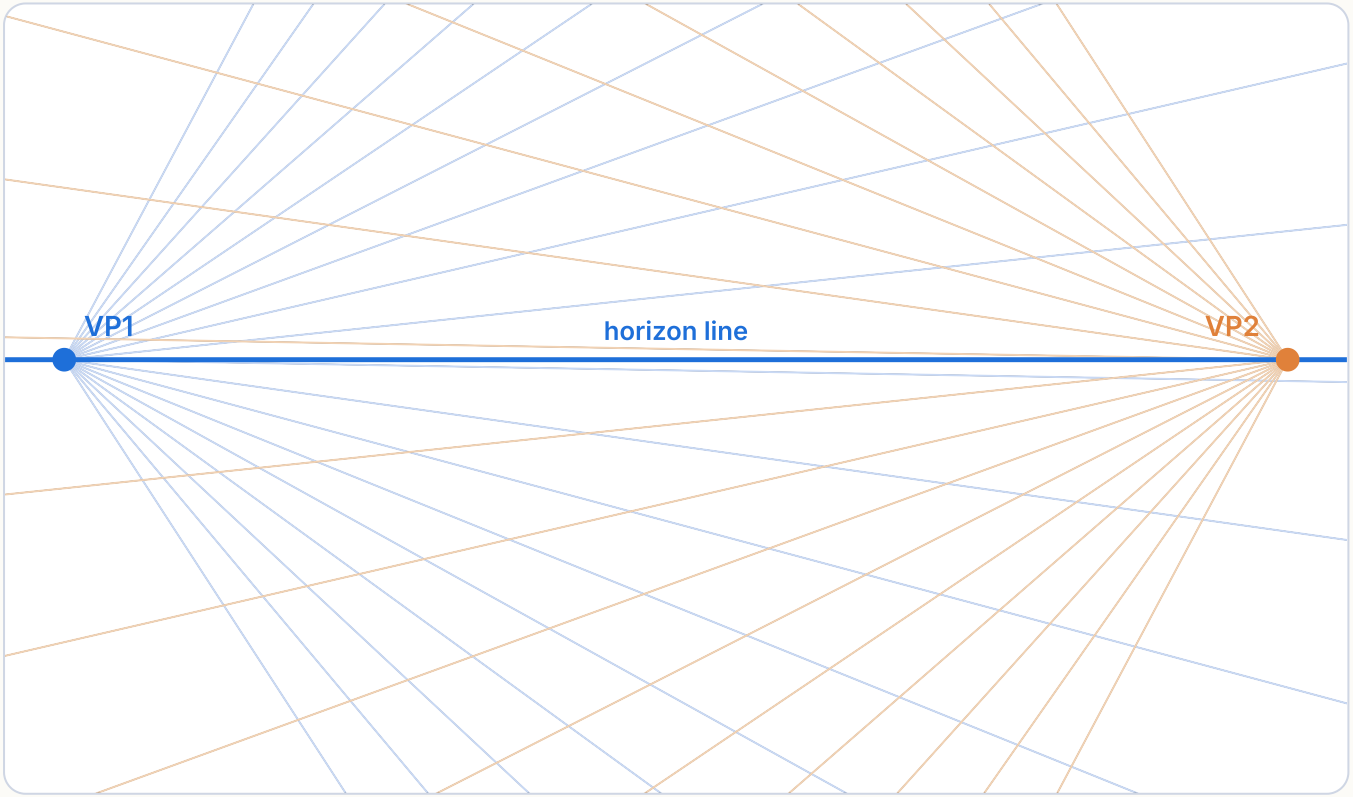
Vanishing points too close together. You get sharp, distorted corners.

Pro tip

If your VPs don't fit on the paper, tape the paper to your desk and mark the points on the desk itself.

PRACTICE SHEET

VP1 in blue · VP2 in orange



4 The Tower

3-point perspective · The dramatic view

20 min

Goal

Find out how far away the third vanishing point should be.

Steps

1. On each frame the horizon is near the top, for a bird's-eye view, with two VPs on it.
2. VP3 sits below: close in A, farther in B, farthest in C (off the page).
3. In each frame, draw the nearest corner of a cube and connect it to all three points.
4. Draw the vertical edges leaning toward VP3 instead of straight up and down.

Check yourself

- Which cube looks the most natural? Circle it.
- Notice how the leaning verticals get closer to parallel as VP3 moves away.

Common mistake

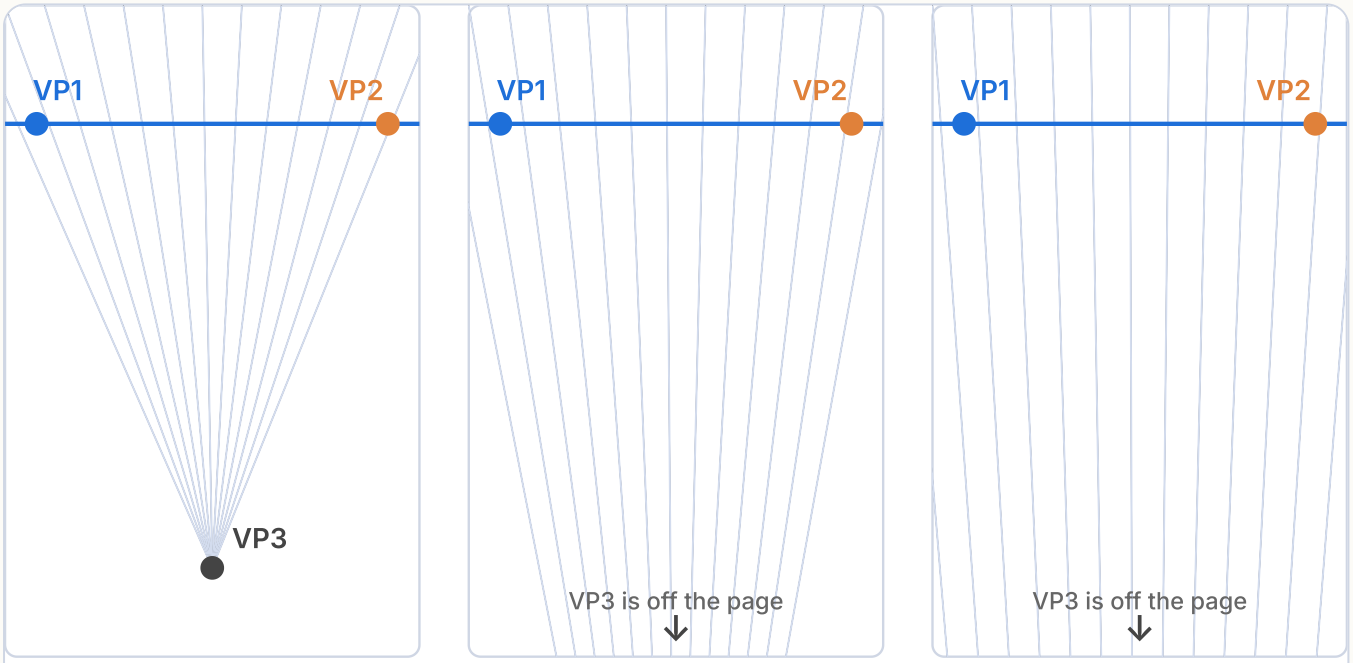
Third point too close. The building turns into a sharp cone.

Pro tip

For a bird's-eye view, push the horizon to the top of the page. For a worm's-eye view, to the bottom.

PRACTICE SHEET

Draw one cube in each frame



A · VP3 close **B · VP3 farther** **C · VP3 farthest**

Which cube looks the most natural? Circle it.

5 Misty Mountains

Aerial perspective · Depth without lines

20 min

Goal

Create depth with value alone, using one pencil.

Steps

1. With one pencil, shade the four boxes from light (1) to dark (4).
2. In the frame, the four ridge lines are drawn faintly. Fill layer 1 (the farthest) with your lightest value and almost no detail.
3. Move forward layer by layer, increasing value and contrast.
4. Save the darkest values and the sharpest details for layer 4, the foreground.

Check yourself

- Each layer is clearly different from its neighbors.
- The farthest layer is light, soft and cool.
- The nearest layer is dark, sharp and detailed.

Common mistake

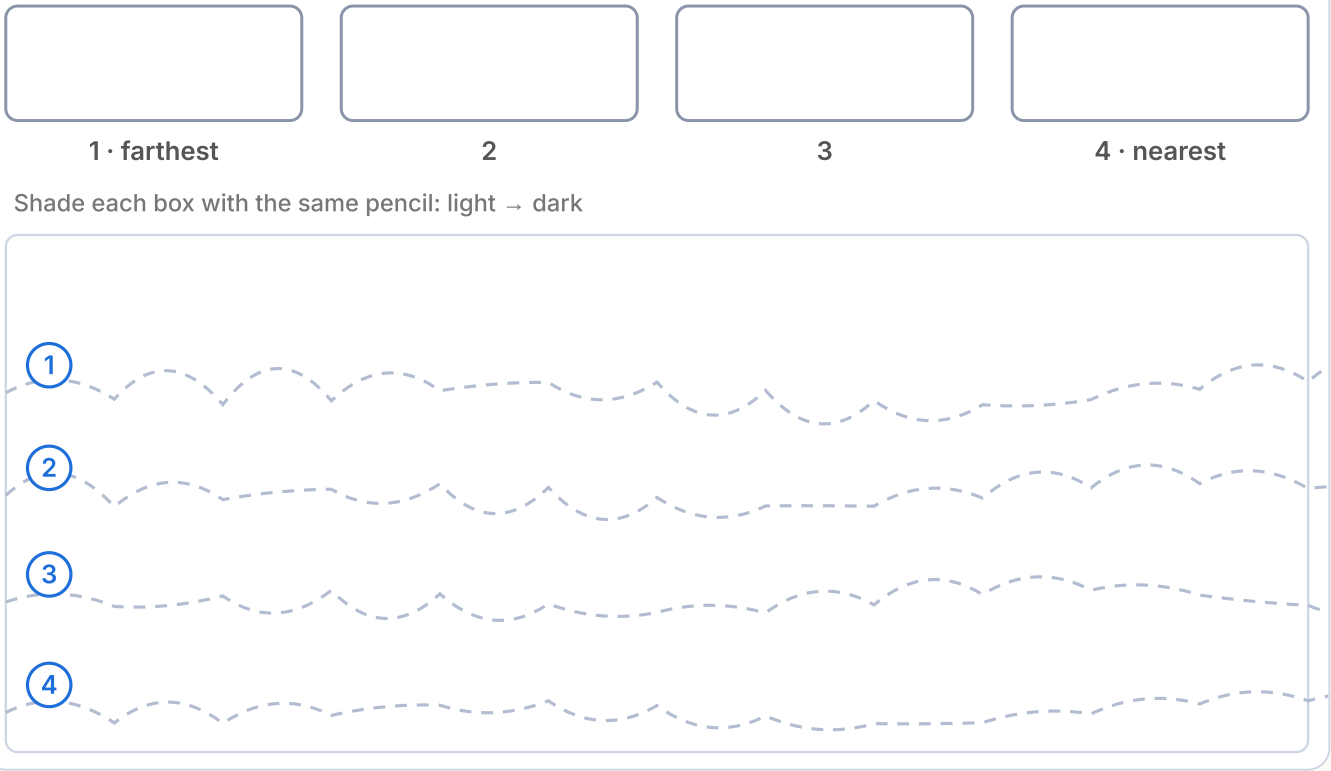
Too much detail in the background. Drawing every tree in the distance kills the depth.

Pro tip

Squint your eyes. Value differences become much easier to see.

PRACTICE SHEET

1 = lightest · 4 = darkest



6 Eye Level

The golden rule · Put every person's eyes on the horizon

10 min

Goal

Train your eye to keep the horizon line at eye level, whatever the distance.

Steps

1. The horizon and ground are drawn. The first person is an example.
2. Draw a standing person on each blue dot. Start at the feet.
3. Make each person's **eyes sit exactly on the horizon line**.
4. Notice that only the size of the body changes with distance. Eye level never does.

Check yourself

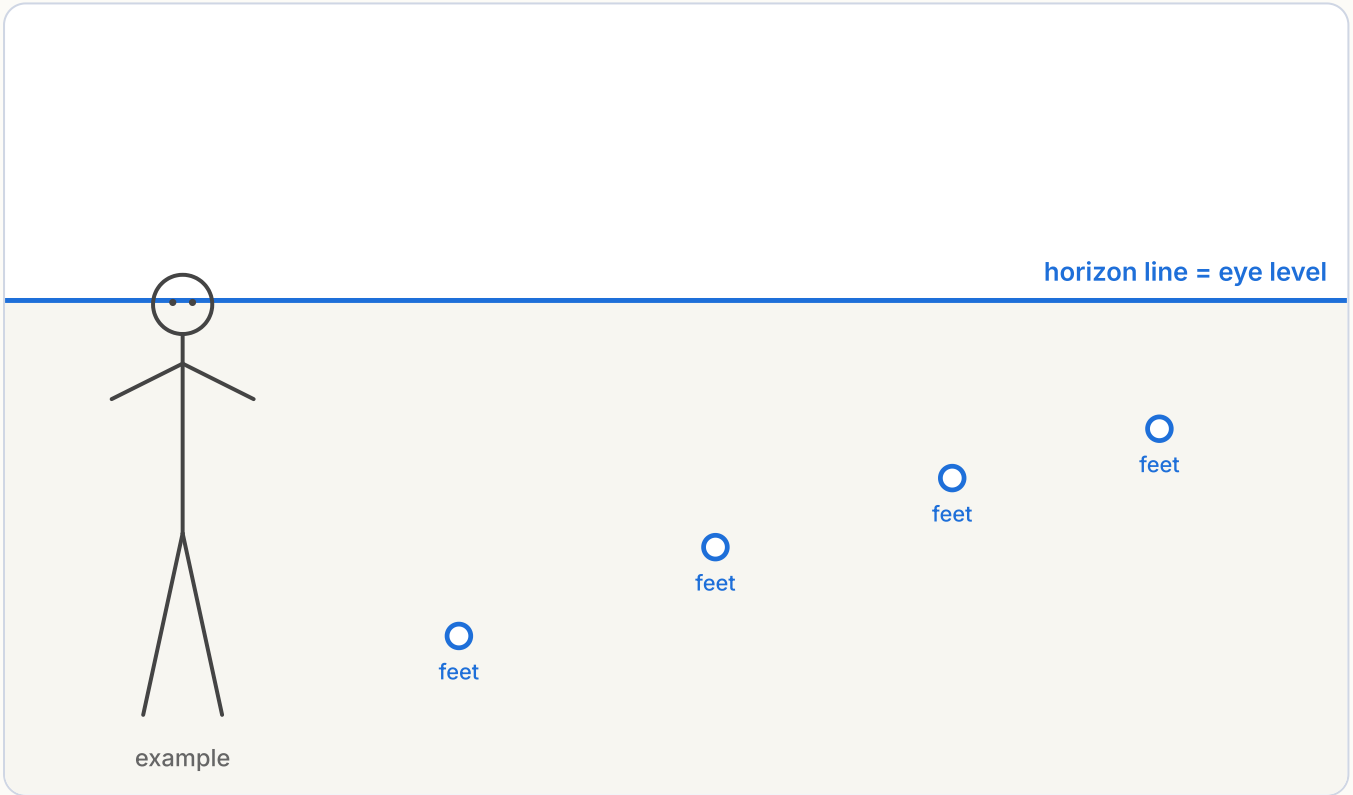
- All five pairs of eyes sit on the same line.
- The farther the person, the smaller the body.

Common mistake

Shrinking far people from the top, so their heads drop below the horizon. Shrink them from the feet up instead.

PRACTICE SHEET

Draw a person on each dot



Your Progress

Tick off each drill and write the date you finished it

☐	**1 · 9 Boxes**	1-point	_____
☐	**2 · The Hallway**	1-point	_____
☐	**3 · 10 Boxes**	2-point	_____
☐	**4 · The Tower**	3-point	_____
☐	**5 · Misty Mountains**	Aerial	_____
☐	**6 · Eye Level**	Golden rule	_____

Show us your drawings!
Snap a photo of your drill pages and tag @perspective.sketch in your story or post.

Want all 7 types explained?
Get the free 7 Types of Perspective cheat sheet and more free files:
ardacubuk22-blip.github.io/PRESPECT-VE_7STEP

What to try next

- Redo the drill you liked least, with a new subject.
- Draw your own desk or room using 1-point, then 2-point perspective.
- Do the 7-Day Perspective Challenge from the cheat sheet.